Seed enquiry checklist: specify retail pack sizes and labelling language · Practical guide

A seed enquiry works best when it is treated as a structured record rather than an informal message. Resellers often mix up three separate things: the products and catalogue quantities being requested, the retail packaging and labelling requirements, and the delivery details. Keeping these apart matters, because a catalogue quantity and its unit do not by themselves confirm the pack size or the labelling language needed for resale. This guide explains how to build a clear, copy-ready enquiry and what to check once a quotation arrives.

Why the three records must stay separate

A structured seed enquiry answers three practical questions without blending them. First, the product record: which variety, catalogue reference, quantity and catalogue unit are being requested? Second, the packaging record: which retail pack size and labelling language should be reviewed? Third, the delivery record: where should the shipment go, and by which date? Separating these records gives the supplier a clear basis for checking what can actually be supplied. It also prevents a catalogue unit from being mistaken for the unit of a finished retail pack, a confusion that becomes costly when orders are later confirmed.

Six details to record for every item

Include the following for each seed item. Record the product identity as the botanical name, variety and catalogue reference. State the catalogue quantity and the unit used in the catalogue request; the unit also helps distinguish similarly named varieties. Then record the intended retail pack size and the unit that defines it, kept separately from the catalogue quantity and unit rather than derived from it. State the required labelling language, and if the requirement differs between products, repeat it with each relevant product instead of leaving it as a general note. Add the destination country and postal code, plus the requested delivery date. Include your business contact details as well, and where practical repeat pack size and labelling language on each product line so neither requirement becomes detached from the correct variety.

A copy-ready enquiry structure

The following format keeps key information visible without assuming which products or pack sizes are available. For each item, write: Product — botanical name, variety, catalogue reference. Catalogue request — quantity and catalogue unit. Retail packaging — requested pack size and pack-size unit. Labelling — required labelling language. Destination — country and postal code. Requested delivery date — the date to include in the review. Business contact — name and contact details. Repeat the product, packaging and labelling lines for every item. If several products share the same pack specification, still show every catalogue reference so the link between each product and that specification stays clear.

Present requests as requests

An enquiry is non-binding, and any arrangements are confirmed in the quotation. Available pack sizes are confirmed in the quotation, so present pack size and labelling language as requested requirements, not as terms already agreed. This framing protects both sides: it tells the supplier what you need reviewed while making clear that availability, prices and shipping conditions have not yet been settled. The destination details belong in the same spirit — the country and postal code are included so that shipping options and documents for the proposed shipment can be reviewed, not because a shipping method has been chosen.

A final check before sending

Before sending, confirm a short list of points. Does every item have a botanical name, variety and catalogue reference? Does every requested quantity have a unit? Are the retail pack size and its unit recorded

separately from the catalogue request? Is the required labelling language stated for each relevant item? Are the destination country, postal code and requested delivery date included? Are the business contact details present? And are pack sizes and labelling arrangements presented as requests rather than confirmed terms? A quick test: can a reader tell which product is involved, how much is requested, what retail pack and labelling language should be reviewed, and where and when delivery is intended?

What to check in the quotation

Submitting an enquiry does not place an order. The supplier reviews the selection and checks availability, prices and shipping conditions before making an offer. When the quotation arrives, read it against your enquiry: see which pack sizes have actually been confirmed and what arrangements have been stated for the requested labelling language and delivery date. Do not assume a requested pack size or labelling arrangement is available unless the quotation addresses it. Comparing quotation to enquiry line by line keeps the three records intact and makes any gaps easy to raise before committing.

Links

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